



PASSWORD MANAGEMENT POLICY

ORGANIZATION: CYBER CONNECT

DEPARTMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

VERSION 1.0

Ref:

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CONTENTS

DOCUMENT INFORMATION	4
VERSION HISTORY	4
INTRODUCTION	5
PURPOSE	5
SCOPE	5
ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES	5
POLICY	5
1. General Rules for Password Management	5
2. Password Creation Requirements.....	6
3. Password Usage	6
4. Password Change and Expiry	6
5. Password Reset Procedure	6
6. Management of Privileged Account Passwords	6
7. Account Lockout Mechanism.....	6
8. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)	6
DOCUMENTATION & RETENTION	7
COMPLIANCE / ENFORCEMENT	7
REVIEW & REVISION.....	7

DOCUMENT INFORMATION

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Disclaimer	

VERSION HISTORY

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1.0	March 25, 2026	Rameen Mughal	GRC Mentor	Draft

INTRODUCTION

This Password Management Policy defines the requirements for creating, using, and protecting passwords within Cyber Connect. It aims to ensure that all IT systems and data remain secure from unauthorized access.

PURPOSE

The purpose of this policy is to establish strong password practices to protect organizational systems, maintain data confidentiality, and reduce the risk of security breaches.

SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees within the IT department of Cyber Connect and covers all systems, applications, and devices managed by the IT team.

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Role	Responsibilities
CEO	• Approves and enforces the policy
IT Officer	• Implements and monitors password policies • Manages password reset requests • Ensures privileged accounts are secured • Monitors audit logs and access activities • Reviews policy annually and recommends updates
IT Employees	• Follow all password creation and usage guidelines • Keep passwords confidential • Report suspected password compromises immediately • Change passwords according to defined schedules • Use approved password managers where applicable

POLICY

1. General Rules for Password Management

- All passwords used within Cyber Connect must be strong and comply with defined complexity requirements.
- All passwords must be kept confidential and must not be shared with any unauthorized person.
- Default passwords must be changed immediately upon first login.
- Passwords must be unique and must not be reused across multiple systems.
- Passwords must be changed periodically as defined by the IT department.
- Storage of passwords in plain text or insecure formats is strictly prohibited.
- Approved password managers may be used to securely store passwords.

2. Password Creation Requirements

- All passwords must be at least **8–12 characters long**.
- Passwords must include a combination of:
 - Uppercase letters
 - Lowercase letters
 - Numbers
 - Special characters
- Passwords must not contain:
 - Usernames
 - Personal information
 - Common or easily guessable words

3. Password Usage

- Users must not share their passwords with colleagues, supervisors, or external parties.
- Passwords must not be written down or stored in accessible locations.
- Users must ensure that passwords are not visible when being entered.
- Passwords must only be used by the authorized account owner.

4. Password Change and Expiry

- Users must not reuse their last **3–5 passwords**.
- In case of suspected compromise, passwords must be changed immediately.

5. Password Reset Procedure

- Password reset requests must only be processed after verifying the user's identity.
- Temporary passwords must be issued securely and must be changed upon first login.
- All password reset activities must be logged and monitored by the IT department.

6. Management of Privileged Account Passwords

- Privileged account passwords must be stronger and more complex than standard user passwords.
- Access to privileged account passwords must be strictly restricted.
- Privileged passwords must be changed more frequently.
 - Must be changed **every 60 days** for standard privileged accounts.
 - Must be changed **immediately** if there is any suspected compromise.
- Sharing of privileged account credentials is strictly prohibited.

7. Account Lockout Mechanism

- User accounts must be locked after **5 unsuccessful login attempts**.
- Locked accounts can only be reactivated through a secure verification process.

8. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

- MFA must be enabled for all critical systems and accounts where possible.

- In cases where MFA is not available, additional security controls must be applied such as VPN Access, Allowed IP Addresses.

DOCUMENTATION & RETENTION

All password-related activities, including account creation, password changes, resets, privileged access, and audit logs, will be retained for a **minimum of six (6) years** or longer if required by organizational policy or applicable law.

COMPLIANCE / ENFORCEMENT

Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination, and may also result in regulatory or legal penalties.

REVIEW & REVISION

This policy will be reviewed annually by the Security Officer and IT leadership, and updated as necessary to reflect technological, organizational, or regulatory changes.

Managing Director

Date: 25/03/2026